perplexity

Semester Campus Marketplace

Semester can extend beyond coursework into a **verified campus opportunity marketplace**: one place for students to discover programs, jobs, services, events, and communities. Existing student-engagement platforms commonly centralize organizations, events, opportunities, communications, and participation records, which supports this direction.[1] [2]

Marketplace categories

Category	Student capabilities	Organization capabilities
Campus jobs	Search openings, save roles, upload a résumé, apply, track status	Post roles, screen applications, message candidates, schedule interviews
Internships	Filter by career area, location, pay, credit eligibility, remote/hybrid options	Employers and career staff publish verified listings, manage application pipelines
Study abroad	Explore programs, compare costs and terms, bookmark options, begin applications	Global-learning office manages programs, eligibility, deadlines, documents, decisions
Clubs and organizations	Discover communities, attend events, apply to join, follow updates	Leaders manage membership, applications, roles, posts, and events
Events and tickets	Browse campus events, RSVP, join waitlists, check in, add to calendar	Hosts publish events, manage capacity, attendance, reminders, feedback
Student services	Find tutoring, advising, wellness, financial aid, accessibility, housing, and career help	Service teams publish availability, intake forms, appointments, and resources
Peer marketplace	Find tutors, study groups, project collaborators, mentors, or approved student services	Moderated matching, verified profiles, availability, reporting controls
Housing and local deals	Browse approved housing, sublets, textbooks, transport, and partner discounts	Institution-approved listings, expiration, reporting, verification

The marketplace should distinguish **institution-verified**, **partner-verified**, **student-posted**, and **unverified external-link** listings. Do not make every posting appear university-endorsed.

Listing lifecycle

```
Draft
  → Submitted for review
  → Approved / Returned for edits / Rejected
  → Published
  → Paused / Filled / Expired
  → Archived
```

Each listing should support:

- Title, summary, media, tags, category, location, and accessibility details.
- Eligibility rules such as major, year, visa/work authorization constraints, GPA, or program requirements.
- Application or registration deadlines in the student's time zone.
- Contact method, privacy settings, and reporting route.
- Employer, office, or club verification status.
- Required disclosures: compensation, fees, credit options, risk/travel notices, and external-site handling.
- Saved searches and personalized alerts.
- View, click, application-start, and conversion analytics.

Study abroad and internships

Study abroad experience

Study-abroad discovery should feel like a guided comparison and application workspace—not just a directory. Education-abroad platforms commonly centralize program discovery, applications, and communications. [3]

Student features

- Search by destination, language, term, discipline, budget, housing, accessibility, internship availability, and credit options.
- Compare programs side by side.
- View estimated costs with clear "estimate" labels.
- Save programs and receive deadline reminders.
- Check preliminary eligibility without presenting it as a final admission decision.
- Ask questions in an approved program discussion space.
- Start one application dashboard with a checklist.
- Upload documents, request recommendations, track approvals, and receive decisions.
- Complete pre-departure learning, safety acknowledgments, and travel documents.
- Connect with approved peer ambassadors or returning participants.
- Access emergency contacts and support resources while abroad.

Staff features

- Build program catalogs and term availability.
- Configure eligibility, capacity, nomination, and deadline rules.
- Create application forms, review queues, decision letters, and document checklists.

- Track incomplete applications and send targeted reminders.
- Manage advising appointments.
- Export approved data for institutional systems.
- Publish only aggregate, policy-approved program analytics.

Internship experience

Internship listings should make the opportunity practical: location, compensation, work arrangement, schedule, skills, supervisor, eligibility, application process, and academic-credit options. International internship providers commonly combine internship searching with location and industry filtering. [4]

Key student functions:

- Career-interest profile and résumé vault.
- Job matching that explains *why* a role may fit.
- Saved applications and deadline tracker.
- Employer messaging only after the student opts in or applies.
- Interview scheduling and preparation resources.
- Offer comparison: pay, hours, location, course credit, visa needs, and benefits.
- Reflection and supervisor evaluation after completion.
- Optional co-curricular record or portfolio artifact.

Key safety controls:

- Employer verification and reporting.
- Scam/risk warnings for requests involving money, personal financial details, or off-platform communication.
- Clear difference between a campus-approved opportunity and an external listing.
- Human review for sensitive or high-risk categories.
- No automated eligibility rejection without a visible appeal or staff-review route.

Clubs and student organizations

A clubs system should support discovery, membership, governance, events, communication, and continuity when student leaders graduate. Digital homes for student groups, membership management, and event tools are common engagement-platform capabilities. [5] [1]

Club directory and discovery

Students can:

- Search by interest, identity/affinity, academic area, service, sport, culture, faith, arts, activism, entrepreneurship, and location.

- Browse featured, new, active, and “beginner-friendly” clubs.
- View purpose, leadership, meeting times, dues, accessibility, and open roles.
- Follow a club without immediately joining.
- Request membership or apply for selective organizations.
- See approved upcoming events and peer connections.
- Report inaccurate, unsafe, or inappropriate content.

Club leader portal

Leaders can:

- Create and edit public club profiles.
- Maintain officer roles and leadership transitions.
- Build membership forms and approval rules.
- Create member-only spaces.
- Publish announcements, files, polls, and event updates.
- Manage RSVP, waitlist, QR check-in, attendance, and post-event feedback.
- Track budgets, requests, and institutional approvals where enabled.
- Create officer handoff checklists and archive materials.
- View aggregate engagement, not unnecessary student surveillance.

Club applications

A configurable application builder should support:

- Short and long responses.
- Multiple-choice and ranking questions.
- Portfolio or file uploads.
- Eligibility acknowledgments.
- Recommendation requests.
- Interview-slot selection.
- Blind-review options where appropriate.
- Reviewer assignment and scoring rubric.
- Decision, waitlist, and appeal workflows.
- Student-facing status: drafted, submitted, under review, accepted, waitlisted, declined, withdrawn.

Avoid exposing applicant rankings, reviewer notes, or private demographic information to club officers unless institutionally approved.

In-app social features

Semester's social layer should be a **campus community product**, not a copy of a broad public social network. It should help students find people, activities, and support while providing strong controls against harassment, misinformation, doxxing, and unwanted contact.

Daily feed

The home feed can combine:

- Course-relevant announcements.
- Club and event updates.
- Internship and study-abroad deadlines.
- Campus service reminders.
- Followed topics and organizations.
- Study-group requests.
- Peer milestones, if the student elects to share them.
- Curated institutional announcements.
- "For you" opportunities based on explicit interests and enrolled-campus context.

Students should control:

- Whether profile activity appears in feeds.
- Who can comment, message, tag, or follow them.
- Which clubs/topics can notify them.
- Whether their attendance, club membership, or application activity is visible.
- Feed personalization and sensitive-topic recommendations.
- Chronological versus recommended feed views.

Academic grades, assignment submissions, accommodation information, counseling/wellness activity, and private application details must never appear in a social feed.

Posts and interactions

Support:

- Text, image, video, link, poll, and event posts.
- Comments, reactions, saves, reposts, and topic tags.
- Content warnings and alt text.
- Accessibility-first captions and transcript support.
- Post editing and deletion.
- Student-controlled visibility: private, direct group, club, course cohort, campus, or public external sharing where allowed.

- Reporting, blocking, muting, and keyword filters.
- Moderator review queue with evidence preservation.
- Rate limits and anti-spam protections.

Communities and group spaces

Space	Membership model	Appropriate use
Club space	Officer-approved or open	Club updates, files, events, member discussions
Course study group	Instructor-created or student-created with safeguards	Peer study coordination; no grade disclosure
Residence/housing group	Verified eligibility	Building/community information
Interest community	Open, moderated, or approval-based	Hobbies, identity, professional interests
Program cohort	Staff-managed	Study abroad, orientation, internships, mentoring
Project team	Membership from course/team system	Files, tasks, discussions, milestones

Private groups still require reporting and safety pathways. “Private” should mean limited membership—not immunity from platform rules or legal obligations.

Messaging and networking

Include:

- Direct messages with consent-based message requests.
- Group chat and event chat.
- Scheduled or auto-expiring event threads.
- Mentorship matching and structured introductions.
- Availability and office-hour booking.
- Optional professional profile: interests, skills, projects, résumé link, and portfolio.
- Contact controls: no messages, message requests only, connections only, organization members only.
- Block, restrict, report, and safety escalation.

Default messaging should be conservative for new students and minors. Never expose a student’s personal phone number, personal email, class schedule, real-time location, or private enrollment data by default.

Feed, trust, and moderation

Feed-ranking rules

Semester should use a transparent ranking system:

1. Always prioritize urgent institutional safety messages.
2. Show followed organizations and explicit subscriptions.
3. Recommend opportunities from stated interests and saved searches.
4. Limit repetitive posts and low-quality engagement bait.
5. Explain recommendations: “Shown because you follow Environmental Science” or “Matches your saved internship preferences.”
6. Offer “not interested,” mute, and reset-personalization controls.
7. Never use grades, disciplinary records, disability accommodations, health data, or private messages for social recommendations.

Moderation system

Moderation tools need:

- Clear community standards.
- Reporting categories: harassment, threat, hate, impersonation, self-harm concern, scam, privacy violation, sexual content, and misinformation.
- Emergency escalation instructions.
- Temporary content limits for repeated abuse.
- Appeals and audit logs.
- Moderator roles with least-privilege access.
- Evidence retention schedules.
- Human review for serious safety actions.
- Institution-controlled policy configuration.

FERPA gives eligible students rights concerning education records and restricts certain disclosures of personally identifiable information; this means Semester must carefully separate social data from protected academic records and enforce institution-specific policies. Public student content should not expose instructor feedback or grades. [6] [7] [8]

Data model and integrations

Core entities

Domain	Essential entities
Marketplace	Listing, provider, verification, category, eligibility rule, application, saved listing
Clubs	Organization, officer role, member, membership request, club application, event
Study abroad	Program, term, provider, application, document, checklist item, decision
Internships	Employer, listing, application, résumé, interview, offer, supervisor evaluation
Social	Profile, privacy setting, follow, topic, post, media asset, comment, reaction, report, moderation case
Messaging	Conversation, participant, message, message request, block, notification
Trust	Verification, policy version, consent, audit event, content action, appeal

Essential integrations

- **SIS/SSO:** verified identity, active enrollment, campus eligibility.
- **LMS:** optional course cohort and study-group context; never import grades into social surfaces.
- **Career systems:** approved internship feeds, applications, appointment scheduling.
- **Study-abroad systems:** program inventory, application status, document workflows.
- **Calendar:** event RSVP and reminders.
- **Payments:** optional club dues or tickets through institution-approved payment workflows.
- **Accessibility tools:** captions, alt text, transcripts, keyboard support.
- **Safety systems:** trusted reporting, escalation, and institutional case management.

Build order

Phase 1: Safe discovery

- Verified profiles and privacy defaults.
- Clubs directory and public pages.
- Event discovery, RSVP, calendar sync, and check-in.
- Marketplace listings for jobs, internships, programs, and campus services.
- Save, follow, search, filters, alerts, and report controls.
- Staff approval and listing moderation.

Phase 2: Applications and communities

- Club membership and application workflows.
- Internship and study-abroad application trackers.
- Club spaces, announcements, comments, and controlled messaging.

- Student profile/portfolio controls.
- Event chat and study-group matching.
- Moderation queue, blocking, appeals, and audit logs.

Phase 3: Connected student life

- Personalized daily feed with explanations and controls.
- Peer mentorship and networking.
- Study-abroad pre-departure and alumni community spaces.
- Internship reflection and co-curricular records.
- Organization analytics and leadership-transition tools.
- Institution-approved payments and external-partner workflows.

The key outcome is a unified **Semester Campus Life** experience: students discover meaningful opportunities, apply and participate without losing track of deadlines, build community safely, and maintain control over their identity and data.

What part should be designed first in more detail: the marketplace discovery experience, the clubs application workflow, or the daily social feed?

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